and garden but not into your house and whisky collection.

When you return from your trip, you review the footage from your comprehensive (some might say over the top) camera surveillance system. You cross Bob off the Christmas card list and make a mental note to ask someone else to look after the plants next time.

The next time you see Bob you confront him about the party. He tries to deny it at first, but when you point out the cameras, he admits everything. He buys you a lovely new Venus fly trap to say sorry. The video cameras show the advantage of having good *audit logs* so that you can find out who did what when things go wrong, and if necessary, prove who was responsible in a way they cannot easily deny.

> **DEFINITION** An ***audit log*** records details of significant actions taken on a system, so that you can later work out who did what and when. Audit logs are crucial evidence when investigating potential security breaches.

You can hopefully now see a few of the mechanisms that are involved in securing an API, but before we dive into the details let’s review what an API is and what it means for it to be secure.

1.2 What is an API?

Traditionally, an API was provided by a software *library* that could be linked into an application either statically or